Manuel Sá

Full-Stack Developer
Software Engineering Graduate Student

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About Me

I am an enthusiast for solving complex problems, whether it's optimizing database queries or designing a deck of cards from scratch. I believe technology should be intuitive, which is why I focus heavily on **Customer Experience**. Although I wasn't formally trained in this reality, I am an **AI (Vibe Coding)** user to accelerate development and ensure faster deliveries without compromising quality. **Hobbies & Communities:** I am a graphic designer in my free time — I love performing arts and design. Outside of code, you can find me performing magic tricks, doing sports, or playing the violin.

Technical Expertise

Expert/Daily Use:	React, Django, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, Git, **AI-Assisted Coding (Copilot/Claude)**, Docker.
Proficient:	C#, Python, Java, **Spring Boot**, **Microservices Architecture**, Node.js, **Agile/Scrum**.
Learning/Exposure:	**AWS**, **Jenkins**, Erlang, Haskell, **Performance Testing**, **On-call rotations**.

Work Experience

Nov 2023 – Present **Full-Stack Developer**
Wisecrop (Multidisciplinary team of 15 people)

- Technical leadership in the redesign of the authentication flow, reducing support requests by 30%.
- Collaboration in an **Agile** environment, actively participating in **Code Reviews** and constant **Refactor** processes to keep technical debt low.
- Performance optimization in the front-end and improvement of complex queries in Django ORM to support over 2,000 active users.
- Integration of data visualization (Highcharts) and interactive maps (Leaflet).

Feb 2022 – Jul 2022 **Curricular Internship**
Centro de Computação Gráfica

- Development of a web dashboard for the Eco-Fire project using React.
- Security implementation with JWT and encryption of sensitive data.

2020 – Present **Graphic Designer & Professional Magician**
Freelance

- Creation of visual identities for international brands. This experience gave me a unique sensitivity to UI/UX and attention to detail.

Education

2024 – Present **Master's in Software Engineering**
ISEP - Inst. Superior de Engenharia do Porto

- **Main Focus:** Requirements Engineering, Distributed Architectures, and Security.
- **Keywords:** Cloud Systems, Scalability, Software Quality.

2021 – 2023 **Bachelor's in Computer Engineering**
FEUP - Faculdade de Engenharia da U.Porto

- **Main Focus:** Algorithms, Operating Systems, and Networks.
- **Keywords:** Data Structures, Low-level Programming, Network Protocols.

Portfolio & Projects

DESOFS - Secure Distributed Service Layer
Technologies: Java, Spring Boot, HATEOAS, DDD, Spring Security
- Implementation of a secure API following **Domain-Driven Design (DDD)** principles.
- **Highlight:** Focus on advanced security (Auth) and API navigability via **HATEOAS**, ensuring a decoupled and scalable system.
- Link: github.com/manelsa1912/Desfofs2025

QSOFT - Performance & Software Quality Lab
Technologies: Java, JMeter, BackstopJS, Jenkins, SonarQube
- Framework focused on **Performance Testing** and **Visual Regression**.
- **Highlight:** Load testing automation and code quality metrics analysis, aligned with high availability needs.
- Link: github.com/manelsa1912/QSOFT2025

BioCantinas - Requirements Engineering & Management
Technologies: React, Vercel, Node, MongoDB
- Complete canteen management system focused on sustainability and resource efficiency.
- **Highlight:** Rigorous requirements gathering and business process modeling for stock and order management.
- Link: github.com/diogojms2/engreq-biocantinas

High-Performance TSP Solver
Technologies: C++, Meta-heuristics, Algorithmic Optimization
- Solver for the *Traveling Salesman Problem* focused on extreme computational efficiency.
- Link: github.com/DuarteNuno/TSP

ODSOFT - Software Design & DevOps Pipeline
Technologies: Docker, Jenkins, CI/CD, Java
- Project focused on the development lifecycle, from software design to automated deployment.
- **Highlight:** Configuration of robust **CI/CD** pipelines with automatic quality validations.
- Link: github.com/diogojms2/odsoft-project

The Mantis Playing Cards - Product Engineering
Technologies: Adobe Suite, Blender 3D, Supply Chain Management
- Physical design and product engineering project sold globally.
- **Highlight:** International production management and rigorous quality control.
- Link: butterflymagicstore.com/blog/mantis...

Personal Portfolio & Digital Showcase
Technologies: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, GitHub Pages, UI/UX Design
- Centralized platform for aggregating engineering projects and creative portfolio.
- Link: manelsa1912.github.io

Soft Skills

- **Team Work & Collaboration:** Experience in teams of up to 15 people.
- **Adaptability:** Ability to switch between design and engineering with ease.
- **Effective Communication:** Developed through years as a professional magician.
- **Problem-Solving:** Focus on practical and efficient solutions.